

Final - Minutes of Neighborhood Meeting of the West End Civic Association

April 10, 2025

Attendance

- WECA officers : Margaret Magner, Pres.; Ajay Khetarpal, VP; Heidi Liu, VP- Outreach; Duane Rollins, Corresponding Secretary; Darlene Pierro, Treasurer
- WECA Block Captains: Noreen Bryan, Maggie Hadley, Rick Mui, Rich Panzer, Jane Pontius
- Other Participants: John Barker, Mary Ann Eull, Pete Fosselman, Don Hadley, Aileen Klein, Leah Larson-Rabin, Zach Larson-Rabin, Louise Lovell, Erin Mahoney, Lt. Matney, Bridget Newton, Tracy Saltarelli, Ken Sonner, Phil Staub, Acting Police Chief Jason West

Call to Order

President Margaret Magner called the meeting to order at 7:05 pm.

Officer Slate

The Nominating Committee presented their recommended slate of Officer candidates for 2025-26, for election by the neighborhood at the coming May meeting. The following slate of candidates was approved unanimously by motion of the Executive Board:

- President - Ajay Khetarpal
- VP - Darlene Pierro
- VP Outreach - Heidi Liu
- Treasurer - Louise Lovell
- Corresponding Secretary- Duane Rollins
- Recording Secretary - Kelly Kalepe (nomination from floor)

Public Safety Report

Lt. Matney gave the monthly report on crime in the area and answered questions.

News and Information

• Guest Speaker: Acting Police Chief Jason West

Acting Chief West discussed significant changes in the Rockville City Police Department, emphasizing internal culture improvements and policy updates since his arrival in the role in November. He highlighted reduced sick leave abuse and a fully staffed department within two months. Traffic concerns were addressed, with plans to add traffic unit officers.

• Guest Speaker: Mary Ann Eull, Trustee of the Rockville Presbyterian Church (RPC)

Mary Ann Eull discussed the sale of the Rockville Presbyterian Church Education Building, noting they have received seven bids, including one from a West End neighborhood family aiming to preserve the nursery school and shelter in their current scope of operation.

Business Items

- **Upcoming Events**

VP of Outreach Heidi Liu gave the report. The annual WECA SpringFest will be on Saturday, May 17 at Lower Monument Park from 12 to 3 pm.

- **Treasurer's Report**

Treasurer Darlene Pierro gave the report.

WECA started the month of March with a balance of \$2,217. In March we had income of \$1,770 made up of \$1,750 from four advertisers in our upcoming Spring newsletter and a donation of \$20. Darlene explained that this is a temporary high point of income for the year, since in April we will pay for the printing of our Spring newsletter. In March we had expenses of \$41.50 for the regular monthly charges for our list serv email technology and our Bank account at BOA. We ended March with a balance of \$3,946.

- **Minutes Approval**

There was a motion to approve the minutes of the March meeting. This passed without objection.

Open Forum

- The gathered community debated WECA's role regarding supporting specific bids for the purchase of the RPC Education Building. It was ultimately decided to facilitate community feedback without endorsing any specific bid. A motion passed, with eight in favor and one against, for WECA to provide information to the community on how individuals can express opinions about the building sale to the RPC leadership.
- Maggie Hadley reminded those present about the upcoming changes in the law making gas powered blowers illegal as of July 1, 2025.

Next Meeting

The next monthly neighborhood meeting will be on May 8, 2025.

Adjournment

The meeting was adjourned at 9:10 pm.